

History of the Liberation War of Bangladesh

1) Different Types of Discrimination Between East and West Pakistan

During the period when Bangladesh was East Pakistan, the people of the eastern wing faced systematic discrimination by the ruling elite of West Pakistan. These inequalities were economic, political, cultural, and social.

➤ **Economic Discrimination**

- East Pakistan's economy was exploited to benefit West Pakistan.
- Despite having more than half of the total population, the economic investment, industry, and resources were heavily biased toward West Pakistan.
- East Pakistan earned valuable foreign exchange through jute and other exports, but reinvestment in the region remained minimal. This caused huge economic inequality between the two wings.

➤ **Political Discrimination**

- Bengalis were not given fair political power despite winning a majority in the 1970 General Election.
- Sheikh Mujibur Rahman's party (Awami League) won most seats in the National Assembly, but the government never transferred power.
- As a result, Bengalis felt denied of their democratic rights and political representation.

➤ **Cultural and Language Discrimination**

- The central government of Pakistan tried to impose Urdu as the sole national language, ignoring Bengali — the language of the majority in East Pakistan.
- This sparked the Language Movement, and laid the foundation for later national demands.

Language suppression was a major cultural injustice.

➤ **Military and Institutional Inequality**

- Senior positions in the army, government services, and bureaucracy were dominated by West Pakistanis.
- East Pakistanis were under-represented in key posts despite being the majority of the population. This led to poor decision-making for East Pakistani interests and widened grievances.

2) Role of Foreign Countries in the Liberation War of Bangladesh

The Bangladesh Liberation War (1971) did not happen in isolation — several foreign countries acted in ways that shaped the war's course and outcome.

1. India

- India played the most significant role in supporting Bangladesh's independence struggle.
- It provided shelter to over a million refugees fleeing Pakistani repression.
- India trained the Mukti Bahini (freedom fighters) and supplied weapons throughout the nine-month conflict.
- Indian military intervention in December 1971 helped defeat the Pakistan Army and hastened victory.
- India officially recognized Bangladesh as an independent nation on 6 December 1971.
- India's support was both humanitarian and strategic.

2. Soviet Union

- The Soviet Union backed India and Bangladesh diplomatically and politically.
- In the United Nations Security Council (UNSC), the Soviets used their veto power to block ceasefire resolutions that would have favored Pakistan.
- Soviet support helped legitimize the Bangladesh cause on the world stage and protected it from diplomatic isolation.
- Their support was crucial for international backing.

3. China

- China supported Pakistan politically and diplomatically due to their strategic alliance.
- China opposed international interference and described the conflict as Pakistan's "internal matter," attempting to limit global pressure against Pakistan.
- China's role was largely in defense of its Cold War ally.

4. United States

- The U.S. government did not support Bangladesh's independence openly, as it wanted to maintain good relations with Pakistan.

- The U.S. provided financial and logistical aid to Pakistan and proposed a ceasefire that would have prevented Pakistan's defeat.
- The U.S. even sent the 7th Fleet to the Indian Ocean as a show of support for Pakistan, although it never engaged in action.
- The U.S. also offered some humanitarian financial aid to India for refugee support without recognizing the independence movement.
- The U.S. was cautious and aligned with Pakistan for strategic reasons.

ICT INDUSTRY

1. History of the ICT Industry in Bangladesh

- **First Computer:** Bangladesh has about six decades of experience in using computers. In its early days, the ICT sector in Bangladesh was mainly focused on hardware operations. The first 'second generation' mainframe computer was installed in 1964 at Dhaka University. Soon after this, several banks and industrial concerns started using computers, mainly for accounting.
- **First Computer Center:** In 1982, a computer center was established at the Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology. This center, later renamed the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, has played a pivotal role in Bangladeshi IT education since its inception.
- **The Innovation of Bangla Writing:** The innovation of software concerning "Bangla writing" on computers materialized in 1987. Mainul Islam managed to write Bangla on an Apple Macintosh computer. With the ability to use Bangla on computers, the value of computers in offices quickly rose.
- **Introduction of the Internet:** After the introduction of the internet in 1996, the development of exportable software and multimedia systems commenced.
- **Journey of BCS:** The Bangladesh Computer Society (BCS), an association of the IT professionals, for instance, was formed in 1979. BCC, the Bangladesh Computer Council, is the consequence of the evolution of the National Computer Committee constituted in 1983.
- **Journey of many Organizations:** In 1997 It is recognized that the ICT industry is a potential sector and it has an impact on the economy. After that in collaboration with industry associations (BCS, BCC, BASIS, and BACCO) and international trade support institutions the government has taken both short and long term measures to support and enhance the development of the domestic sector and increase the export of ICT products. BASIS, established in 1997, promotes the ICT sector through awareness building, practical education for new graduates and paid internships, and training programs for mid-career employees.
- **Connected with Submarine Cable:** Bangladesh got connected with its first undersea cable, SEA-ME-WE 4, in 2006. Development of ICT Sector-2
- **Software Park:** Software Technology Park (STP) at Janata Tower was established in Dhaka in 2015.

- **High Tech Park:** Bangladesh Hi-tech Park Authority is a government agency in Bangladesh dedicated to establish, manage and operate technology business parks throughout the country. Formed in 2010, BHTPA is now implementing the projects including the Kaliakoir Hi-Tech Park in Gazipur District and Jessore Software Technology Park. Planned projects include Mohakhali IT Village in Dhaka, Barendra Silicon City in Paba Upazila of Rajshahi District, and Sylhet Electronic City in Companiganj Upazila, Sylhet. BHTPA is also approving private hi-tech park to implemented by private companies. Thus far, 39 hi-tech parks have been under constructions and approved for construction by BHTPA in different regions in Bangladesh.
- **A2I Project:** Aspire to Innovate (a2i) of the ICT Division supported by UNDP, a special program of the government's Digital Bangladesh agenda, is a key driver of the nation's goal of becoming a developed country by 2041 and in achieving the 2030 Sustainable Development Goals.

2. Key Objectives of the National ICT Policy 2018

National ICT Policy – 2018 (8 Objectives & 55 Themes)

The Bangladesh government's National ICT Policy 2018 aims to transform the country into a knowledge-based society by using technology to achieve national development goals, including aspects of Vision 2021, Vision 2041, and the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

Digital Government (6 Themes)

This objective focuses on leveraging ICT to establish a transparent, responsive, and accountable government. This involves the digitalization of all government services, internal operations, and the implementation of interoperable e-government platforms to provide services efficiently and affordably to citizens, including those in rural areas.

Digital Security (9 Themes)

A critical goal is to create a secure and inclusive digital ecosystem by safeguarding individuals, organizations, and national assets from various cyber threats like hacking, data breaches, and cyber-terrorism. The policy led to the enactment of the Digital Security Act 2018 and the establishment of institutions like the national

Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT) to monitor and respond to cyber threats effectively.

Social Equity, Universal Access (8 Themes)

This objective strives to ensure that the benefits of the digital revolution are accessible to all citizens, including persons with disabilities and those in remote areas, thereby promoting social equity and equal opportunity. This involves strengthening local-level ICT infrastructure and promoting rural connectivity and development.

Education, Research, Innovation (9 Themes)

The policy promotes the integration of ICT into education at all levels (primary, secondary, and tertiary) to improve quality and ensure that all universities provide global standard ICT education. It also encourages research and development (R&D) in emerging technologies like AI, blockchain, robotics, and biotech through tech parks and incubators.

Skill Development, Employment Generation (5 Themes)

A primary focus is on developing a large pool of world-class ICT professionals to meet the demands of both local and global markets. The policy aims to train a significant number of youth in IT and freelancing, increase the number of software engineers and cybersecurity professionals, and revamp the ICT curriculum in schools and universities.

Strengthening Domestic Capability (7 Themes)

This objective centers on reducing dependency on foreign technology by encouraging private investment, promoting the local software and hardware industries, and increasing local content. It encourages the establishment of production facilities for components and peripherals and promotes joint ventures between local and foreign entrepreneurs.

Environment, Climate & Disaster Management (5 Themes)

The policy aims to use ICT and GIS-based systems to address environmental challenges and manage disasters effectively. This includes collecting and disseminating information on environmental problems to create awareness and using IT systems for national-level planning and conservation.

Enhancing Productivity (6 Themes)

This objective focuses on promoting and facilitating the use of ICT in all sectors of the economy—including agriculture, health care, and transportation—to improve efficiency and boost overall productivity. It aims to simplify e-commerce regulations, promote digital payments, and create an enabling environment for startups and tech entrepreneurs.

3.Strengths and Weaknesses of the ICT Industry in Bangladesh

➤ Strength

- 1.One of the biggest strengths of the ICT sector is the young and educated workforce.
- ICT industry in Bangladesh is still relatively small. Looking at the characteristics of the market, and the growth of ICT services and products exported from Bangladesh over recent years we can conclude that the significance of the ICT sector for the Bangladeshi economy will grow in the near future.
- According to BASIS estimations within the next five years 5% of Bangladesh's total GDP will come from the software and IT services sector and over 1,50,000 Software and IT professionals will be working in the Bangladeshi IT industry by 2025.
- Export earnings from software and IT-related services of the last 12 months crossed the \$1 billion mark.
- It is internationally recognized that if the use of internet increases by 10%, the gross domestic product (GDP) of a country will go up by 1%.
- Bangabandhu Hi-Tech Park at Kaliakoir will create jobs for 1,00,000 people

➤ Weaknesses

- Infrastructure and power shortages.
- Lack of reliable infrastructure.
- Internet speed, bandwidth, and electricity
- Lack of focus and scale to take up large-scale long-term projects.

- Lack of soft skills in Bangladesh (If you have 100 candidates for the job, probably just 2 will have the right soft skills)
- Gap between what the industry needs and IT graduates.
- Lack of investment
- Political instability.

ECONOMY

QUESTION: Describe linear and circular economy. Which model would you prefer and why?

Answer:

Linear Economy

A linear economy follows a one-way flow of resources: take → make → use → dispose.

Raw materials are extracted from nature, transformed into products, used by consumers, and finally thrown away as waste.

Key features:

- Heavy dependence on virgin (new) resources
- Products are often designed for short life spans
- Large amount of waste generation
- Limited recycling or reuse
- Causes environmental pollution and resource depletion

Example:

Buying a plastic bottle, using it once, and then throwing it into a landfill.

Circular Economy

A circular economy is a regenerative system where resources are kept in use for as long as possible. Instead of waste, materials are reused, repaired, refurbished, recycled, or recovered.

Key features:

- Focus on reduce, reuse, recycle
- Products are designed for durability and repair
- Waste is minimized or eliminated
- Uses renewable energy where possible
- Supports environmental sustainability and long-term economic growth

Example:

Recycling plastic bottles into new products or repairing electronic devices instead of discarding them.

I prefer the circular economy model.

For Bangladesh, the circular economy is significantly better than the linear model because it tackles pollution, resource depletion, and climate change while boosting sustainable growth, especially in the crucial textile sector, by reusing materials, creating new value chains (like textile recycling clusters providing jobs and reducing imports), and moving away from the wasteful "take-make-dispose" system, although challenges like technology, infrastructure, and behavior change remain.

Reasons:

- Environmentally sustainable – reduces pollution, waste, and greenhouse gas emissions.
- Efficient use of resources – conserves limited natural resources.
- Economic benefits – creates new jobs in recycling, repair, and innovation sectors.
- Long-term growth – supports sustainable development rather than short-term consumption.
- Suitable for developing countries like Bangladesh, where resource scarcity and waste management are major challenges.

Question -02: Explain the nature of the economy of Bangladesh?

Answer: Nature of the Economy of Bangladesh (Easy & Detailed Explanation)

The economy of Bangladesh has several important characteristics that explain how the country produces income, creates jobs, and develops over time. From the PDF, we can understand the nature of Bangladesh's economy in the following ways:

1. Mixed Economy

- Bangladesh follows a mixed economy.
This means both the government and private sector play important roles.
- The government controls key sectors like power, energy, railways, and large infrastructure.
- The private sector operates industries, businesses, banks, garments factories, and services.

This combination helps balance social welfare and economic growth.

2. Free Market–Oriented Economy

Bangladesh patronizes a free market economy.

- Prices of most goods and services are determined by demand and supply.
- Private entrepreneurs can start businesses freely.
- Competition is encouraged.

This helps increase production, investment, and innovation.

3. Growing Role of the Private Sector

The private sector has developed effectively in Bangladesh.

- Most industries, especially RMG (Ready-Made Garments), are privately owned.
- Private banks, IT companies, real estate, and service sectors are expanding.
- Employment opportunities mainly come from the private sector.

The economy depends heavily on private entrepreneurship.

4. Public–Private Partnership (PPP)

Bangladesh has recently introduced Public–Private Partnership (PPP).

- Government and private companies work together on big projects.
- Examples: roads, bridges, power plants, metro rail.

PPP helps reduce government burden and speeds up development.

5. Dependence on Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)

The economy emphasizes foreign direct investment.

- Foreign investors invest in garments, telecom, energy, and manufacturing.
- Government offers tax holidays and incentives.

FDI helps bring capital, technology, and employment.

6. Export-Oriented Economy

A major part of Bangladesh's income comes from exports.

- The Ready-Made Garments (RMG) industry earns the highest export income.
- Bangladesh is one of the largest garment exporters in the world.

Export dependency helps earn foreign currency but also creates risk if global demand falls.

7. Dependence on Remittance

Bangladesh is highly dependent on foreign remittance.

- Millions of Bangladeshi workers work abroad (Middle East, Europe, Asia).
- They send money back home, which supports families and the economy.

Remittance strengthens foreign reserves and reduces poverty.

8. Labor-Based Economy

Bangladesh has a large supply of cheap and hardworking labor.

- Labor-intensive industries like garments and construction are popular.
- The country benefits from a demographic dividend (young population).

Labor strength is a key advantage for economic growth.

9. Loan-Dependent Economy

Bangladesh is highly dependent on national and international loans.

- Loans are taken from World Bank, IMF, ADB, and other countries.
- Loans are used for mega projects and development programs.

While loans help development, excessive dependence can create debt pressure.

10. Open Economy

Bangladesh maintains an open border relationship with the world.

- Trades with many countries.
- Imports raw materials, fuel, and machinery.
- Exports garments, jute goods, leather, and agricultural products.

Openness helps global integration but increases competition.

11. Aid and Development Partner Dependent

The economy depends on development actors and donor organizations.

- Foreign aid supports health, education, infrastructure, and poverty reduction.
- NGOs play a strong role in rural development.

Aid supports growth but long-term dependence is a weakness.

12. Planned Development Economy

According to the Constitution (Article 15), Bangladesh follows a planned economy.

- Five-Year Plans (FYP)
- Perspective Plan 2021–2041
- Delta Plan 2100
- Vision 2041 & Vision 2071

Planning helps achieve sustainable development and reduce poverty

QUESTION-03: Describe key barriers to achieve Bangladesh's SDG goal.

ANSWER:

Key Barriers to Achieve Bangladesh's SDG Goals

Bangladesh has made good progress in many development areas such as poverty reduction, education, and economic growth. However, achieving all 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) by 2030 is challenging. From the PDF and related development issues, several major barriers can be identified.

1. Corruption

Corruption is one of the biggest barriers to achieving SDGs in Bangladesh.

- Misuse of public funds reduces the effectiveness of development projects.
- Resources meant for health, education, and poverty reduction often do not reach the real beneficiaries.
- Corruption weakens public trust and discourages foreign investment.

Without transparency and accountability, SDG targets cannot be achieved efficiently.

2. Political Instability

Political instability seriously affects sustainable development.

- Frequent political unrest, strikes, and conflicts delay development projects.
- Long-term planning becomes difficult.
- Investors lose confidence, slowing economic growth.

Stable politics are essential for long-term SDG planning and implementation.

3. Weak Governance and Bureaucratic Problems

inadequate government and bureaucratic structures.

- Slow decision-making
- Lack of coordination among ministries
- Inefficiency in implementation of policies

Poor governance reduces the impact of SDG-related programs.

4. Aid and Loan Dependence

Bangladesh is highly dependent on foreign aid and international loans.

- Excessive dependence creates pressure on national finances.
- Loan repayment reduces funds available for social development.
- Aid dependency sometimes limits national policy independence.

Sustainable development requires self-reliance, not long-term dependence.

5. Rapid Population Growth

Overpopulation is a major challenge.

- High population increases demand for food, housing, education, and healthcare.
- Pressure on land, water, and natural resources increases.
- Job creation cannot keep pace with population growth.

Population pressure makes it difficult to achieve SDGs related to poverty, health, and environment.

6. Unemployment and Lack of Skills

There are lack of skilled and sound manpower.

- Many young people are unemployed or underemployed.
- Education is often not aligned with job market needs.
- Technical and ICT skills are insufficient.

Without skilled human resources, SDG goals related to decent work and economic growth are hard to achieve.

7. Inequality

Inequality remains a serious barrier.

- Income inequality between rich and poor
- Urban–rural development gap
- Gender inequality in employment and wages

SDGs focus on “leaving no one behind,” but inequality slows inclusive development.

8. Climate Change and Natural Disasters

Bangladesh is one of the most climate-vulnerable countries in the world.

- Floods, cyclones, river erosion, and sea-level rise damage lives and infrastructure.
- Agricultural production is frequently affected.
- Climate disasters increase poverty and displacement.

Environmental challenges directly threaten SDGs related to climate action, food security, and poverty.

9. Land Scarcity

We are facing land scarcity as a challenge.

- High population density limits industrial expansion.
- Agricultural land is shrinking due to urbanization.
- Infrastructure projects face land acquisition problems.

Limited land resources make sustainable urban and industrial development difficult.

10. Presence of Black Money and Money Laundering

Illegal financial activities are major obstacles.

- Black money reduces government revenue.
- Money laundering harms financial stability.
- Weakens trust in the banking system.

Without financial discipline, funding SDGs becomes difficult.

11. Poor Planning and Coordination

lack of proper planning and coordination.

- Overlapping responsibilities among organizations
- Weak monitoring and evaluation
- Poor implementation of development plans

Even good policies fail without effective coordination.

12. Improper Role of Institutions

Several institutions do not function properly.

- Weak role of regulatory bodies
- Limited effectiveness of media and watchdog organizations
- Inadequate diplomatic experience in foreign negotiations

Strong institutions are essential for SDG success.

13. Limited Financial Freedom

lack of financial freedom.

- Small businesses struggle to access loans.
- High interest rates discourage entrepreneurship.
- Financial exclusion limits economic participation.

Financial inclusion is vital for poverty reduction and economic growth.

Conclusion

Although Bangladesh has achieved remarkable progress and is often called an “Emerging Tiger of Asia”, achieving the SDGs faces serious challenges. These barriers include:

- Corruption and weak governance
- Population pressure and unemployment
- Climate change and natural disasters
- Inequality and lack of skilled manpower
- Poor planning and financial mismanagement

Final Statement

To overcome these barriers and achieve the SDGs, Bangladesh must ensure good governance, political stability, skill development, climate resilience, anti-corruption measures, and inclusive growth. Only then can sustainable development become a reality for future generations.

Question-04: Discuss the historical background of Bangladesh economy

Answer: Historical Background of the Bangladesh Economy

The economy of Bangladesh has passed through several important stages since independence in 1971. Each political period introduced different economic policies that shaped the country's development path. The historical background of the Bangladesh economy can be discussed era by era.

1. Post-Independence Period (1971–1975): Sheikh Mujibur Rahman Era

After independence, Bangladesh faced severe economic problems.

- The country was devastated by the Liberation War of 1971.
- Industries, infrastructure, communication systems, and agriculture were badly damaged.
- Poverty, food shortage, and unemployment were widespread.

To rebuild the economy, the government adopted a nationalization policy.

Main features of this period:

- Major industries, banks, insurance companies, and trade were brought under state ownership.
- The economy followed a socialist and state-controlled model.
- Government aimed to ensure equality and rebuild the war-torn economy.

However, lack of experience, inefficiency, corruption, and poor management reduced productivity. As a result, economic growth remained slow.

2. Shift toward Denationalization (1976–1981): Ziaur Rahman Era

After 1975, Bangladesh moved away from strict state control.

- The government introduced denationalization policies.
- Many state-owned industries were returned to private ownership.
- Private sector participation was encouraged.

Key developments:

- Promotion of free market principles
- Encouragement of foreign investment
- Emphasis on agricultural development and rural economy

This period marked the beginning of a mixed economy, combining government control with private enterprise.

3. Expansion of the Private Sector (1982–1990): H. M. Ershad Era

During this time, the focus on the private sector increased further.

- Denationalization policies continued.
- Private entrepreneurs were encouraged to invest in industry and trade.
- Structural adjustment programs were introduced with support from international organizations.

Economic features:

- Expansion of private industries
- Increased role of international financial institutions
- Gradual integration into the global economy

Although some growth occurred, political instability and weak governance limited overall progress.

4. Trade-Oriented Economy (1991–1996 & 2001–2006): Khaleda Zia Era

This period marked an important change in economic direction.

- Bangladesh adopted trade liberalization policies.
- Import and export barriers were reduced.
- The country strengthened economic relations with India, China, USA, and other nations.

Major achievements:

- Rapid growth of the Ready-Made Garments (RMG) industry
- Expansion of foreign trade
- Increased role of remittances from migrant workers
- Bangladesh became more integrated into the global trading system.

5. Investment- and Development-Focused Economy (1996–2001 & 2008–Present): Sheikh Hasina Era

This period brought significant economic transformation.

- Strong emphasis on Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)
- Large-scale mega development projects
- Promotion of international migration and remittances

Key initiatives:

- Bay of Bengal Industrial Growth Belt (BIG-B)
- Improvement of infrastructure (bridges, power plants, roads, metro rail)
- Long-term development planning such as:
 - Five-Year Plans
 - Perspective Plan 2021–2041
 - Delta Plan 2100
 - Vision 2041 & Vision 2071

Poverty reduction, per capita income growth, and human development indicators improved significantly.

6. From “Bottomless Basket” to “Emerging Tiger”

In the early years, Bangladesh was called a “bottomless basket” by Henry Kissinger, meaning it was seen as hopelessly aid-dependent.

However, over time:

- Poverty has reduced
- Per capita income has increased
- Bangladesh is included in Goldman Sachs’ “Next 11” emerging economies

Today, Bangladesh is recognized as an emerging developing economy.

Conclusion

The historical background of the Bangladesh economy shows a gradual transition:

- From a state-controlled economy
- To a mixed and market-oriented economy
- With increasing emphasis on trade, private sector, foreign investment, and planned development

Despite challenges such as corruption, population pressure, and climate risks, Bangladesh has made remarkable progress and continues to move toward sustainable economic development.

